

HOLIDAYS / VISAS SOP

1. LEAD MANAGEMENT SOP

Lead Sources:

- Meta Ads
- Website Enquiry
- Walk-in
- WhatsApp
- Referral
- Corporate

Step 1: Lead Response Time

1. Response Timeline

- All leads must be responded to within 15 minutes of lead generation or capture.
- This applies to leads from all sources: Meta ads, website, WhatsApp, phone calls, walk-ins, email inquiries, or any third-party platforms.

Purpose:

- Quick engagement increases the likelihood of lead conversion.
- Reduces risk of competitor outreach capturing the lead.

2. Mode of Initial Contact

Step 1 – Call:

- Call the lead first to establish direct communication.
- Introduce yourself, your travel agency, and the services relevant to the lead (e.g., Schengen/US/UK visas, holiday packages).
- Keep the conversation concise, professional, and engaging.
- Identify client eligibility and readiness.

Step 2 – WhatsApp Follow-Up:

- If the call is not answered, immediately send a WhatsApp message.
- Include:
 - Your name & agency name
 - Reference to their inquiry (destination or visa type)
 - A clear CTA: “Please share a convenient time for a call” or “Click here to start your application”
- WhatsApp ensures the lead sees your message even if they miss the call.

3. Lead Status Updates

- Immediately update CRM / lead tracking sheet after every contact attempt.
- Track the following statuses:
 - 1) Contacted – Answered
 - 2) Contacted – No Answer
 - 3) Follow-Up Scheduled
 - 4) Quote Sent
 - 5) Payment Pending
 - 6) Not Interested
 - 7) Closed / Converted
- Ensure all notes about client eligibility, preferred travel dates, and special requests are recorded.

Purpose:

- Maintains accurate records for sales reporting, follow-ups, and performance metrics.
- Allows other team members to see lead history and avoid repeated outreach.

4. Escalation & Monitoring (Team Leader / Manager):

- If a lead is not contacted within 15 minutes, escalate to the Holidays/Travel Manager (auto CRM feature).
- Monitor response time daily to ensure compliance.
- KPIs to track:
 - Average lead response time

- % of leads contacted within 15 minutes
- Lead conversion ratio

5. Best Practices

- Use call scripts for consistency and professionalism (Will be created separately).
- Keep WhatsApp messages short, personalized, and action oriented.
- Prioritize high-value or paid ad leads first.
- Avoid delays during peak hours; shall assign backup staff if needed.

Step 2: Lead Qualification Script

1. Initial Approach by Consultant

- Contact Method: Call the lead first (WhatsApp follow-up if no answer)
- Tone: Professional, friendly, and consultative
- Introduction:

“Hello Mr. ABC, this is Suhail from Get2Vacations. I’m following up on your travel enquiry to assist you with the best options for your trip.”

2. Qualification Questions

The consultant must ask the following 7 key questions:

1. Destination:
 - Purpose: Identify visa requirements, travel logistics, and package suitability
 - Example: “Which country or countries are you planning to visit?”
2. Travel Dates:
 - Purpose: Determine urgency, package availability, and airfare availability
 - Example: “When are you planning to travel?”
3. Number of Adults / Children / Infants:

- Purpose: Helps calculate package costs, hotel rooms, transfers, and visa applications
- Example: “How many adults and children will be traveling?”

4. Budget Range:

- Purpose: Align package recommendations with client affordability
- Example: “What is your approximate budget for this trip? Or How much are you willing to spend on this trip?”

5. Visa Required:

- Purpose: Check eligibility, document requirements, and processing timeline
- Example: “Do you require assistance with a visa?”

6. Preferred Hotel Category:

- Purpose: Customize hotel options (3*/4*/5*) and tailor quotation
- Example: “Do you have a preferred hotel category or standard you would like us to arrange?”

7. Purpose of Travel:

- Purpose: Understand trip type for better package suggestions (e.g., honeymoon, leisure, business)
- Example: “Is this trip for leisure, honeymoon, family vacation, or business?”

3. Lead Categorization

After collecting responses, mark the lead based on urgency:

Lead Type	Definition	Action Priority
Hot	Travel within 30 days	Immediate follow-up; high-priority quotation; rapid visa assistance
Warm	Travel within 1–3 months	Follow-up within 2 hours; prepare quotation; monitor interest
Cold	Exploring / Travel >3 months away	Add to nurturing list; occasional follow-ups; maintain engagement

CRM Action:

- Update lead type in CRM / sheet immediately after qualification
- Record all answers to the 7 questions for future reference
- Schedule follow-up according to lead type

4. Consultant Notes & Best Practices

- Ask all 7 questions in every lead conversation; do not skip.
- Maintain a friendly yet professional tone; avoid sounding like an interrogation.
- Listen actively to objections or additional requests; note them in CRM.
- For Hot leads, escalate to senior consultant / priority processing for quotation and visa documentation.
- For Cold leads, do not push aggressively; instead, add to email/WhatsApp nurturing campaigns.

5. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

- % of leads successfully qualified within 1 call
- Number of Hot/Warm leads vs total leads received
- Lead-to-conversion ratio by category (Hot/Warm/Cold)
- Response time for Hot leads

2. PACKAGE CREATION SOP

1. Ready Package (Static Packages)

Static Packages: Pre-designed holiday packages that are pre-costed, standardized, and ready for sale.

Key Features:

Feature	Details
Pre-costed	All costs, including hotel, transfers, sightseeing, and optional meals, are already calculated.
Fixed Markup	Standard profit margin applied; no ad-hoc pricing adjustments.
Standard Inclusions	Includes common components such as hotel stay, airport transfers, guided tours, and optional travel insurance (as per package).
Approved by Department Head	Packages must be reviewed and authorized by the Holidays Department Head before going live. Ensures accuracy, profitability, and operational feasibility.

Benefits:

- Quick to sell; minimal preparation required
- Easy for consultants to communicate and close leads
- High operational efficiency with pre-approved suppliers and services
- Reduces errors in pricing and inclusions

Process:

1. Check package availability with supplier.
2. Confirm rates and services included.
3. Apply fixed markup as per approved structure.
4. Upload package in CRM / website for sale.
5. Send to client immediately upon inquiry.

Customized Package

Customized Packages: Tailor-made holiday packages prepared individually for each client based on their requirements.

Key Features:

Feature	Details
Supplier Rate Check	Verify current hotel, transfer, and sightseeing rates with suppliers. Essential for dynamic pricing.
Flight Costing	Include airfare based on requested travel dates, class, and airline preferences. Consider fare rules, cancellation, and baggage charges.
Visa Costing (if required)	Calculate visa fees, processing charges, and additional documentation costs (Schengen, US, UK, or worldwide).
Insurance Add-On	Offer optional travel insurance; include premium in quotation if client agrees.
Markup Applied as per Margin Structure	Apply profit margin according to the company's approved margin structure; adjust based on package complexity.

Benefits:

- Tailored solutions for client-specific needs (dates, hotels, destinations)
- Ability to upsell premium services and optional add-ons
- Can accommodate complex itineraries (multi-city trips, customized experiences)
- Flexibility in responding to high-value clients or special requests

Process:

1. Gather client requirements via Lead Qualification Script.
2. Check supplier availability and rates.
3. Prepare detailed quotation including flights, hotels, visa, insurance, and other add-ons.
4. Apply approved markup.
5. Submit quotation to client and follow up per Lead Follow-Up SOP.
6. Confirm services only after client approval and payment (advance or full).

Comparison: Ready vs Customized Packages

Feature	Ready Package	Customized Package
Preparation Time	Minimal	Moderate to High
Pricing	Fixed / pre-approved	Dynamic based on client requests
Flexibility	Low	High
Inclusions	Standardized	Tailored to client requirements
Approval	Department Head	Consultant + Department Head (for pricing & margin)
Best For	Quick conversions, general holidays	High-value clients, complex itineraries, special requirements

Markup Structure (Example)

- Land package: 12-18%
- Flights: AED 150-400 per ticket
- Visa: Fixed margin
- Insurance: 20-30%

(We can adjust based on our company policy.)

3. QUOTATION SOP

1. Quotation Content Requirements

Every quotation, whether for a Ready Package, Customized Package, or Complex Itinerary, must include the following details:

Component	Details / Purpose
Destination Name	Specify the exact country/city or cities being proposed. Helps client understand the scope of travel.
Travel Dates	Include start and end dates, or indicate flexibility if applicable. Essential for flights, hotel booking, and visa planning.
Hotel Details	Mention hotel name, star category, room type, number of rooms, meal plan, and check-in/check-out timings.
Inclusions	Clearly list services included in the package: hotel, transfers, sightseeing, meals, travel insurance (if any), visa assistance.
Exclusions	Specify what is not included, e.g., airfare taxes, optional excursions, personal expenses, tips, visa fees (if applicable). Prevents client disputes.
Visa Details	Mention visa type, fees, processing timeline, and documents required (if applicable). Essential for Schengen, US, UK, or worldwide visas.
Payment Terms	Clearly state: advance required, balance payment timeline, non-refundable amounts, and payment modes.
Cancellation Policy	Include supplier-specific cancellation rules, refund conditions, and deadlines. Highlight any non-refundable services.
Price Validity	Mention the date/time until which the quoted price is valid. Helps create urgency and protects against supplier rate fluctuations.

2. Quotation Response Time

Timely delivery is critical for lead conversion. Follow these guidelines:

Package Type	Response Time	Notes / Exceptions
Ready Packages (Static)	Within 30 minutes	Pre-costed and pre-approved; quick delivery expected.
Customized Itinerary	Within 2 working hours	Requires supplier rate check, flight costing, visa calculation, insurance add-ons.
Complex Itinerary	Maximum 6 hours	Multi-country or complex itineraries requiring multiple suppliers. Exception: South East Asia (Japan & South Korea) – may

		require longer due to dynamic rates & limited availability.
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Best Practices:

- Prioritize Hot leads for immediate response.
- Use quotation templates to reduce time and maintain consistency.
- Ensure accuracy before sending; double-check pricing, dates, and inclusions.
- Attach any supporting documents (hotel confirmation, flight options, visa checklist) if available.
- Update CRM with quotation sent timestamp for tracking and reporting.

3. Approval & Quality Control

- Ready Packages: Department Head approval done during package creation; quotation can be sent immediately.
- Customized / Complex Packages:
 - Consultant prepares the quotation
 - Department Head reviews pricing, markup, and inclusions (High Value files)
 - Approval logged in CRM/email before sending to client
- All quotations must maintain professional formatting, clear terms, and branding.

4. Follow-Up After Quotation

- Follow the Lead Follow-Up SOP after sending quotation:
 - Same day evening follow-up for Hot and Warm Leads
 - Next day for Cold leads
- Document client feedback in CRM for further action.
- Track quotation-to-booking conversion rate for monitoring and improvement.

4. FOLLOW-UP AND COMMUNICATION SOP

◆ Follow-Up 1: Same Day (Evening)

Purpose: Confirm quotation receipt & initiate engagement

If Call is Answered:

- Confirm proposal received
- Clarify doubts
- Reinforce urgency

If No Answer:

- Send WhatsApp message: "Tried reaching you regarding your travel enquiry. Please let me know a convenient time to call."
- Send brief email (if available) attaching quotation again
- Mark CRM as "FU1 - No Answer"

◆ Follow-Up 2: Day 2 (Morning)

Purpose: Re-engage & identify objections

If Call is Answered:

- Ask for feedback
- Identify budget/decision concerns
- Offer revised options

If No Answer:

- Send follow-up WhatsApp reminder
- Send voice note (optional - more personal impact)
- Update CRM as "FU2 - No Answer"
- Schedule evening retry

◆ Follow-Up 3: Day 2 (Evening)

Purpose: Create urgency & decision push

If Call is Answered:

- Inform about availability / fare validity
- Ask for confirmation timeline

If No Answer:

- Send urgency message:
“Availability and fares are subject to change. Kindly confirm to secure the current price.”
- Mark CRM as “FU3 – No Response”
- Schedule Final Reminder

♦ Follow-Up 4: Day 3 (Morning) – Final Reminder

Purpose: Last opportunity before closure

If Call is Answered:

- Confirm decision
- Offer last assistance

If No Answer:

- Send Final Message:
“We will release the booking today due to no confirmation. Please let us know if you would like to proceed.”
- Send email (formal closure warning)
- Mark CRM as “Final Reminder – No Response”

♦ Day 4 – Closure (Non-Responsive Leads)

If client remains unresponsive after all attempts:

Procedure:

- Release any blocked services
- Update CRM as “Closed – No Response”
- Stop active follow-ups
- Add to remarketing database (if applicable)

Special Scenarios

- Phone Switched Off: Retry after 3–4 hours same day
- Invalid Number: Send email immediately and mark as “Invalid Contact”
- Client Reads WhatsApp but No Reply: Continue as per schedule until Final Reminder
- Client Requests Call Later: Schedule specific time and treat as priority

Compliance Rule

A lead cannot be marked as “Closed – No Response” unless:

- 4 call attempts completed
- 2 WhatsApp messages sent
- 1 Final Reminder sent
- All logged in CRM

5. PAYMENT SOP

Booking Confirmation Rules:

1. Minimum 50% Advance Payment

- A minimum of 50% advance payment is mandatory to initiate booking confirmation.
- Advance payment is required to block and secure hotel rooms, flights, transfers, tours, or any land services.
- No services will be held or blocked beyond supplier time limits without receipt of advance payment.
- The advance amount must reflect in the company account or valid payment proof must be shared before processing.
- Verbal confirmations or email approvals without payment will not be treated as confirmed bookings.

Purpose:

To secure inventory, minimize cancellation risk, and protect the company from supplier penalties.

2. 100% Payment for Non-Refundable Bookings

- For all non-refundable or instant purchase bookings (e.g., promotional airfares, special hotel offers, peak season deals), 100% payment is mandatory upfront.
- These bookings cannot be cancelled, amended, or refunded once issued/confirmed.
- Clients must be informed clearly in writing about non-refundable terms before collecting payment.
- Written approval from the client is required before issuing non-refundable services.

Purpose:

To avoid financial liability arising from non-refundable supplier policies.

3. Balance Payment Before D-2 (As Per Cancellation Policy)

- The balance payment must be cleared before D-2, i.e., 2 days prior to the supplier's final payment deadline.
- For each service (hotel, land package, or flight), the supplier's last date of payment will be considered the reference for D-2.

- Failure to pay the balance by this timeline may result in automatic cancellation or release of blocked services as per the supplier's policy.
- Any cancellation fees or penalties imposed due to delayed balance payment will be charged to the client.

Purpose:

To ensure bookings are fully secured and to comply with supplier payment terms, minimizing the risk of service cancellation or penalties.

4. No Service Confirmation Without Payment Proof

No booking will be processed, ticketed, or confirmed without valid payment proof.

Acceptable payment proof includes:

- Bank transfer confirmation
- Online payment receipt
- POS transaction slip
- Official company payment confirmation

Screenshot without transaction reference or pending transaction proof will not be considered valid confirmation.

Booking confirmation timeline (ticketing/voucher issuance) begins only after payment validation.

Purpose:

To maintain financial control, avoid fraudulent claims, and ensure accounting compliance.

Compliance Rule

- Sales team must clearly communicate payment terms at quotation stage.
- Payment deadlines must be mentioned in writing (email/WhatsApp).
- CRM must reflect payment status before marking booking as confirmed.
- Accounts team confirmation is mandatory for large-value bookings.

6. BOOKING CONFIRMATION SOP

Before Payment (Blocking Stage)

- Block hotel and land arrangements with DMC for 24–48 hours (as per supplier policy)
- Block flight seats (if applicable) as per airline fare rules (time-limit based)
- Share payment deadline with client clearly (mention fare/room release time)
- Record blocking deadline in CRM
- Follow up with client before blocking expiry (minimum 4 hours prior)

B. After Payment Received

- Reconfirm hotel and land arrangements with DMC immediately
- Convert blocked services to confirmed status
- Issue hotel & land vouchers within 48 hours of payment receipt
- Issue flight tickets within 30 minutes of payment receipt (subject to fare validity)
- Update CRM status to “Confirmed”
- Send payment receipt to client

C. Pre-Departure Process

- Send final itinerary PDF 2 days prior to departure
- Reconfirm all services with DMC 72 hours prior to arrival
- Share emergency contact details (DMC + company)
- Send visa checklist (if required)
- Send travel tips & destination guidelines
- Send travel insurance copy (if included)
- Verify flight schedule changes 24–48 hours prior

7. DOCUMENTATION SOP

Timeline: Must be completed and sent to client 72 hours before departure

Responsible: Assigned Holiday Consultant

1. PASSPORT VALIDITY CHECK

Verification Points:

- Passport validity minimum (subject to destinations):
 - 6 months validity from return date (most destinations)
- Minimum 2-3 blank pages
- Correct passport number (match with tickets & visa)
- Name spelling matches flight ticket exactly
- No damage to passport

What to Send to Client:

- Reminder note:

Please carry original passport used for booking.

- Reconfirm passport number via WhatsApp/email (Only in case original passport has not being shared)

Internal Control:

- Re-verify passport copy saved in CRM
- Cross-check with airline PNR

2. VISA DOCUMENT CHECK

Verification Points:

- Visa validity dates
- Visa type (single/multiple entry)
- Entry validity
- Duration of stay allowed
- Passport number printed correctly

- Name spelling accurate

Send to Client:

- Visa copy (PDF)
- Print instruction:

Kindly carry 2 printed copies of visa.

- Immigration tips (if required)

Extra Checks:

- Transit visa requirement.
- Additional documents required at arrival?
- Return ticket attached?

3. TRAVEL INSURANCE CHECK

Verification Points:

- Insurance dates cover full travel period
- Coverage includes:
 - Medical emergency
 - COVID (if applicable)
 - Repatriation
- Correct passenger names
- Passport number correct

Send to Client:

- Insurance certificate (PDF)
- Emergency insurance contact number
- Claim process instructions

4. FLIGHT TICKET VERIFICATION

Double Check:

- Passenger names correct (as passport)

- Departure & return dates correct
- Flight numbers
- Terminal details
- Baggage allowance
- Seat selection (if applicable)
- Meal selection (if applicable)
- Transit duration & airport change (if any)

Send to Client:

- E-ticket copy
- PNR number
- Online check-in instructions
- Airport reporting time:

Please reach airport 3 hours before departure.

5. HOTEL VOUCHER CHECK

Verification Points:

- Hotel name & address
- Check-in & check-out dates
- Room type
- Meal plan (BB/HB/AI)
- Number of guests correct
- Child age mentioned properly
- Special requests mentioned (if any)

Send to Client:

- Hotel voucher PDF
- Hotel contact number
- Google Maps location link
- Early check-in policy note

AIRPORT TRANSFER DETAILS

Check:

- Arrival flight details shared with DMC
- Pickup name board confirmation
- Emergency driver contact
- Pickup location instructions

Send to Client:

- Driver contact number
- Meeting point instructions
- Local DMC emergency number

7. TOUR & ACTIVITY CONFIRMATION

Verify:

- Tour dates
- Pickup time
- Pickup location
- Dress code (if applicable)
- Voucher attached
- Contact person

Send:

- Day-wise tour schedule
- Important timing reminders

8. EMERGENCY CONTACT SHEET (Very Important)

Prepare a simple PDF including:

- Travel Consultant Name
- Office landline
- Emergency mobile number

- On Ground contact
- Insurance emergency
- Airline contact
- Hotel contact
- Embassy contact (if international)

9. FINAL ITINERARY PDF (Professional Format)

Include:

- Day-wise plan
- Hotel details
- Tours
- Flight details
- Emergency contacts
- Important travel tips
- Visa info

10. FINAL CLIENT CONFIRMATION MESSAGE

Send 72 hours before departure:

Sample Message:

Dear XYZ,

Please find attached your final travel documents for your upcoming trip.
Kindly review all details carefully and confirm receipt.

Wishing you a pleasant and memorable journey.
We remain available for any assistance.

INTERNAL CONTROL CHECK (Department Head Review)

For bookings above AED 25,000:

Margin checked
All vouchers verified
DMC payment cleared
Client balance cleared
Special requests handled

CRM STATUS UPDATE

Change pipeline stage to:
“Travel Ready”
After departure:
“Travel In Progress”

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

Sending wrong hotel dates
Visa validity not matching travel dates
No baggage details mentioned
Driver not informed of flight delay
Child age mismatch in hotel booking

PRO TIP FOR UAE MARKET

Send documents in 2 formats:

- PDF (official)
- WhatsApp compressed version (easy access during travel)

8. POST-SALES SOP

After client travels:

- Send feedback message
- Request Google review
- Ask for referral
- Add to remarketing list

9. CANCELLATION AND REFUND SOP

1. CANCELLATION REQUEST RECEIPT

- ◆ Rule 1: Written Confirmation Mandatory

No cancellation will be processed without:

- Email from registered email ID
OR
- WhatsApp message with written confirmation

Must mention:

- Booking reference number
- Passenger name
- Travel dates
- Reason for cancellation

2. IMMEDIATE INTERNAL ACTION (Within 2 Hours)

Consultant must:

1. Check cancellation policy of:
 - Airline
 - Hotel
 - DMC
 - Visa
 - Insurance
 - Tours & transfers
2. Verify payment status:
 - Full payment received?
 - Partial payment?
 - Outstanding balance?
3. Update CRM status:
“Cancellation Requested”

3. SUPPLIER POLICY VERIFICATION

- ◆ Airline
 - Refundable / Non-refundable?
 - Refund penalty?
 - No-show charges?
 - Credit shell option?
- ◆ Hotel / DMC
 - Free cancellation window?
 - Partial refund?
 - 100% retention?
 - Rebooking allowed?
- ◆ Visa
 - Visa fee is NON-refundable (standard rule)
 - Service charge non-refundable
- ◆ Insurance
 - Usually non-refundable once issued
 - Check policy clause

4. SERVICE CHARGE POLICY (Company Protection)

Your agency must clearly apply:

Suggested Structure:

- Service fee: AED 150–300 per person (depending on package value)
OR
- 5–10% handling fee

Service fee is:

- Non-refundable
- Separate from supplier penalty

5. CLIENT COMMUNICATION FORMAT

Within 24 hours, send:

Example Cancellation Response:

Dear XYZ,

We have reviewed the cancellation request for your booking reference 1234

As per policy, the applicable cancellation charges are as follows:

Airline: AED

Hotel/DMC: AED

Visa: Non-refundable

Service Charges: AED

Total refundable amount: AED

Kindly confirm your acceptance so we may proceed with the cancellation process.

No cancellation without client approval.

6. REFUND CALCULATION PROCESS

Formula:

Total Amount Paid

- Supplier Penalty

- Visa Charges

- Service Charges

= Refundable Amount

Double verify before sending.

Department Head approval required for:

- Refund above AED 10,000
- Disputed cases

7. REFUND TIMELINE POLICY

Clearly communicate:

- Airline refunds: 15–30 working days
- DMC refunds: 7–21 working days
- Credit shell: As per airline validity

Mention:

“Refund timelines depend on supplier processing time.”

Never promise fixed refund date unless funds received.

8. PROCESSING REFUND

Once funds received:

1. Inform client
2. Process bank transfer within 3–5 working days
3. Send payment proof
4. Update CRM status:
“Cancelled – Refunded”

9. NO-SHOW POLICY

If client does not travel and no cancellation requested:

- 100% charges applicable
- No refund
- Document proof in CRM

10. FORCE MAJEURE CASES

Applicable in:

- Medical emergency
- Visa rejection
- Airline cancellation
- Natural disasters

Process:

- Request medical certificate (if applicable)

- Attempt rescheduling before cancellation
- Negotiate with supplier

Department Head must intervene in such cases.

11. CREDIT SHELL OPTION (Retention Strategy)

Before refund, always offer:

- Date change
- Destination change
- Travel credit valid for 6–12 months

This protects revenue.

12. INTERNAL CONTROL CHECK

Consultant must ensure:

- Cancellation request saved
- Supplier confirmation saved
- Refund calculation approved
- Client acceptance received
- Refund proof saved

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- Cancelling before checking full policy
- Promising full refund
- Ignoring service charge
- Not documenting approval
- Processing refund before receiving supplier refund

10. DAILY REPORTING SOP

Consultant must submit daily:

- Leads received
- Quotes sent

- Converted
- Revenue generated
- Pending cases
- Issues faced

Daily 10-minute review meeting.